

Meeting Summaries of November 13

Date: November 13

Time: 8:00–8:40 PM(PDT)

Attendees: Prof. Jan, Dr. Javed, Dr. Yue and Feng

Topic: Feng's summation of previous work, outline and primary goals for next steps

Summary of Discussion

- Feng gave a brief summary of lessons learned from previous work at beginning stage, summarized into three aspects:
 - Avoid being idealistic and it needs focusing on primary problems at the beginning stage;
 - Be cautious about designing and testing "big" ideas, always check the priorities of ideas and the primary goals when making decisions;
 - Good ideas should inherit some solid summarization of related works, should not solely rely on intuition and imagination.
- Feng reported the plan to reproduce the baseline work in 2008 by Jian, which is set as the primary goal at this stage. There might be some new questions asked during the reproduction, but the priority will be given to finishing the reproduction first if any delaying-factors appear.
- Feng set an important date to finish the baseline reproduction with its integration of the proposed methods in the proposal: December 25th, 2025.
- Feng asked the reference letters in applying for PhD programs, Prof. Jan suggested to make a wish-school list and check out their application due dates so that the submission can all be prepared efficiently.
- Prof. Jan recommended a book - "Numerical Ecology with R" that illustrates some complementary methods for the reproduction work. Feng should reference the relevant chapters and methods in the book when reproducing the work.

Decisions Made

- The reproduction work is good, and it should reference the book "Numerical Ecology with R" along the way. It is crucial for the later work that the reproduction should be done quick and well. ¹
- The submission of letters for PhD application can be time-dispersed, therefore it needs to check the submission deadlines and set the schedule accordingly.

Action Items

- Feng will reproduce the baseline work from Jian with reference to the book, and will report stage results in next meeting.

¹That is to say, Feng needs to gear up, keep passion for the work and focus on problem solving.

- Feng will make a wish-school list and check their deadlines for application, prepare the materials accordingly for each school.

Follow-Up

Temporarily next meeting time: November 20 at 1:00 PM (PDT)

Supportive materials

- A meeting recording has been restored on Google Drive.